UU-B-338c
March 20, 1964

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. UU-B-00338b (GSA-FSS)
October 31, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. UU-B-338a
January 27, 1958

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, FLEXIBLE-TAPE TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The binders covered by this specification are loose-leaf, flexible-tape (strap) type fasteners, stiff, canvas-bound covers, open back, two-slot, side and end opening, with and without sheet holding bars, and with and without a center ratchet-type locking device.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types, sizes, styles, classes, and tape widths.* The loose-leaf binders shall be of the following types, sizes, styles, classes, and tape widths, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I.—Side opening for 9- by 6-inch sheet.

Type II.—End opening for stock sheets.
- Size 1.—3-3/4 by 9 inches.
- Size 2.—3-3/4 by 8-1/2 inches.
- Size 3.—8-1/2 by 14 inches.
- Size 4.—11 by 14 inches.
- Size 5.—5 by 8-1/2 inches.

Style 1.—With center ratchet-type locking device and with sheet-holding bars.

Style 2.—With center ratchet-type locking device and without sheet-holding bars.

Style 3 (type I only).—With buckle-type locking devices and without sheet holding bars.

Rated capacity:
- Class 1.—2 inches.
- Class 2.—4 inches.
- Class 3.—3 inches.
- Class 4.—6 inches.
- Class 5.—6-3/4 inches.
- Class 6.—7 inches.

Tape widths: 3/8, 1/2, 5/8, and 3/4 inch.

1.2.2 *Colors.* (See 3.1.3 and 3.1.5.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or requests for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-B-623—Book Cover Board.
UU-P-31 — Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing.
CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-566 — Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 — Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.
PPP-T-60— Tape, Pressure Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof, for Packaging and Sealing.

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Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 66—Steel, Chemical Composition and Hardenability.
Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-W-530—Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130—Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

(Copies of the Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. The materials shall conform to applicable specifications and standards to the extent specified herein. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the best quality used for the purpose in commercial practice.

3.1.1 *Steel.* The steel used for covers, locking devices, binding sticks, and sheet holding bars shall be corrosion resistant conforming to AISI identification number 304 of Fed. Std. No. 66 or steel treated to resist corrosion.

3.1.1.1 *Metal finish.* All metal parts which will be exposed upon completion of the fabrication of the binders shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested in accordance with 4.4.3.

3.1.2 *Cover board.* The cover board shall be book cover board conforming to Specification UU-B-623 having a minimum thickness of 0.108 inches.

3.1.3 *Binding material.* The binding material shall be army duck weighing not less than 6 ounces per square yard when tested as specified in 4.4.1 and shall have a 2-ply warp and 2-ply filling. The color of the material shall be gray or green, as specified (see 6.2).

3.1.4 *Lining material.* The lining material for inside faces of the covers shall be a suitable commercial paper having a minimum basis weight of 70 pounds per ream (24 by 36—500) when tested as specified in 4.4.2. The color of the lining material shall harmonize with the binding material.

3.1.5 *Tapes.* The tapes shall be flexible tapes conforming to type I of Specification MIL-W-530, and shall be gray or green in color, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2 Construction. The binder shall consist of two separate covers held together by two flexible tapes and shall be adjustable to hold either a single sheet or any number of sheets up to the rated capacity.

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3.2.1 *Covers.*

3.2.1.1 *Styles* 1 *and* 2. The top and bottom covers shall be a commercial type fabricated from steel specified in 3.1.1 not less than 0.015 inch thick. The covers shall be stiffened with and bound to the cover board specified in 3.1.2 according to commercial practice, except that the top cover board shall contain a cut-out section to accommodate the center ratchet-type locking device.

3.2.1.2 *Style* 3. The covers for style 3 binders shall be made of the cover board specified in 3.1.2.

3.2.2 *Binding.*

3.2.2.1 *Styles* 1 *and* 2. The covers shall be bound with a continuous piece of the binding material specified in 3.1.3. The binding material shall be carried over the inside face of the covers not less than 1/2 inch beyond the edges on three sides only. The slotted metal tape carriers located on the inside face of the top cover shall not be covered. The binding material shall be securely and smoothly glued in place. The lining material specified in 3.1.4 shall be securely and smoothly glued in place over the binding material. The cut-out portion of the inside face of the top cover shall not be covered.

3.2.2.2 *Style* 3. Covers and binding sticks shall be bound and hinged with a continuous piece of the binding material specified in 3.1.3. The binding material shall be carried over the inside face of the covers at least 1/2 inch beyond the edges and securely and smoothly glued in place. Each hinge shall consist of at least two thicknesses of duck with one thickness joined to the inside face of the cover. The lining material specified in 3.1.4 shall be securely and smoothly glued in place over the binding material and the hinge layer joined to the inside face of the covers.

3.2.3 *Locking devices.*

3.2.3.1 *Styles* 1 *and* 2. The ratchet-type locking device, made of the material specified in 3.1.1 and centrally located in the inside face of the top cover, shall be securely riveted at the top to the center of the book cover board and at the bottom to the center of the slotted metal tape carrier and shall not cut or mutilate the tapes. The tapes shall be riveted to the crossbar of the locking device.

3.2.3.2 *Style* 3. The buckle-type locking devices, made of the material specified in 3.1.1 and suitable for the tape widths as applicable, shall be riveted to the inside surface and over the slots of the top binding stick only. The locking devices shall not cut or mutilate the tapes.

3.2.4 *Application of tapes.*

3.2.4.1 *Styles* 1 *and* 2. One end of the tape shall be carried through the slots of the bottom binding stick and through the slots of the lower metal tape carrier and fastened securely to the inside surface of the bottom cover. The free ends of the tapes shall pass through the sheet body, the slots in the top binding stick, the slots in the top metal tape carrier and riveted securely to the crossbar of the ratchet-type locking device.

3.2.4.2 *Style* 3. One end of the tapes shall be carried through and fastened to the under side of the bottom binding stick or shall be equipped with a suitable stop plate to prevent its being pulled through the slot in the binding stick. The free end of the tape shall pass through the sheet body and the top binding stick and shall then be firmly gripped by the buckle-type locking device. The free end of the tape shall be tipped or shall be so treated that it can easily be inserted through the sheet body, the slots in the binding sticks and the buckle-type locking device.

3.2.5 *Binding sticks.*

3.2.5.1 *Styles* 1 *and* 2. The binding sticks shall be made of the material specified in

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3.1.1, not less than 7/16 inch wide by 1/16 inch thick. The binding sticks shall be hinged to the slotted metal tape carriers of the top and bottom binder covers. Two slots for the insertion of tapes shall be provided in each binding stick of such size that the tape shall pass through readily without undue binding or looseness.

3.2.5.2 *Style* 3. For style 3 binders, the binding sticks shall be made of steel or fiberboard suitable for the purpose, not less than 3/4 inch wide by 1/16 inch thick. Two slots for the insertion of tapes shall be provided in each binding stick of such size that the tape shall pass through readily without undue binding or looseness.

3.2.6 *Binding stick slots (all styles) and metal tape carrier slots (styles 1 and 2).* The slots, with a tolerance of ± 1/32 inch, shall be equidistant from the side edges of the binder and shall be spaced as follows:

Type	*Size*	*Inches on center*
I		6
II	Size 1	2
	Size 2	2
	Size 3	4-1/2
	Size 4	7
	Size 5	2-3/4

3.2.7 *Length of tapes.* The length of the tapes for rated binder capacity shall be as follows:

Rated capacity (class)	*Length (inches), minimum*
1	4
2	8
3	6
4	12
5	13-1/2
6	14

3.2.8 *Sheet holding bars.* The sheet holding bars shall be made of the material specified in 3.1.1 and shall be furnished with style 1 of type I and II binders, as applicable.

3.3 Performance. The loose leaf binders shall be capable of opening and closing, the mechanism capable of operating smoothly without breakdown and shall be evaluated as specified in 4.3.1.6 when tested in accordance with 4.4.3. The materials of which the binders are constructed shall be capable of withstanding the tests specified in section 4.

3.4 Dimensions. The sizes of the binders as to sheet size and capacity shall be as specified (see 1.2.1). The outside dimensions of the binders shall be sufficiently larger than the filler sheets to protect them and the index tabs extending up to 1/2 inch beyond the outer edge of the filler sheets as applicable.

3.5 Identification marking. The manufacturer's name, or trademark of such known character as to be easily identified, shall be printed or stamped on the inside of one cover of the binder. When specified, the contract number and date of manufacture shall also be printed or stamped on the inside of one cover of the binder in accordance with MIL-STD-130. In addition, when specified, the words "Property U.S. Government" shall be included in the marking.

3.6 Workmanship. The finished binders shall be clean, well made, and uniform in color. All metal components shall have smooth edges and surfaces and be securely fastened. The quality shall conform to the levels established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of

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the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. (See 6.2.)

4.1.1 *Sampling for inspection and tests.* Inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. For purposes of sampling an inspection lot shall consist of all end items of the same type, class, style, size, and color made with the same materials from the same production run.

4.2 **Inspection of components.** Quality assurance provisions for components described shall be in accordance with referenced subsidiary specifications to the extent applicable, except that the requirements of this specification shall govern in the event of conflict. The supplier shall inspect and test components for the characteristics listed in table I. The sample unit shall be 1/2 yard full width of the binding material, 36 square inches of each type of steel used, and 1 square yard of the lining material.

4.3 **Inspection of the end item.**

4.3.1 *Examination of the end item.* The end item and the preparation for delivery of the end item shall be examined in accordance with 4.3.1.1, 4.3.1.2, and 4.3.1.3. The lot size for purposes of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105 shall be expressed in units of one binder for examination in 4.3.1.1 and 4.3.1.2 and one shipping container for examination in 4.3.1.3. The inspection level and acceptable quality level (AQL) for each examination shall be as specified in 4.3.1.4.

4.3.1.1 *Visual examination of the end item.* The end item shall be examined for defects in design, construction, appearance, workmanship, and as indicated in table II. The sample unit shall be one finished binder.

TABLE I.—*Testing of components*

Component	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Number determinations per unit	Results reported as—		Inspection level	AQL
					Pass or fail	Numerically to nearest—		
Binding material.	Weight per square yard	3.1.3	4.4.1	5		0.1 ounce	S-1	6.5
	Ply of warp and fill	3.1.3	Visual	1	X			
Lining material.	Basis weight	3.1.4	4.4.2	1		Pounds per ream	S-1	6.5
Metal.	Corrosion resistance (all exposed metal parts)	3.1.1.1	4.4.3	1	X			

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TABLE II.

Examine	Defects
Style, type, and size.	Other than as specified.
Construction.	Variation from two covers held by two web straps.
	Failure to adjust from single to multisheet capacity.
Color.	Other than as specified.
	Any significant nonuniformity.
General workmanship.	Any tear or hole.
	Any dirty area.
	Any rough edges or surfaces.
Binding material.	Other than army duck.
	Any failure to lie smoothly or adhere snugly.
	Any area not securely glued.
	Any splicing, piecing, or noncontinuous construction in cover.
Paper lining.	Any non-glued area.
	Any bulge or wrinkle.
	Any obvious misalignment with edges of cover.
	Any failure to keep the inner ends of outside binding well fastened on all sides.
	Color not in harmony with that of binding material.
Binding sticks.	Any more or less than two.
	Any more or less than two slots per stick.
	Any slot of improper size causing undue binding or looseness of tape.
Hinges (styles 1 and 2).	Not of specified material.
	Any non-secure attachment to cover.
	Any restriction in bending action between binding stick and cover.
Hinges (style 3).	Composed of less than two thicknesses of duck.
	Material other than binding material.
	Any non-secure attachment to cover or binding stick.
	Any restriction in bending action between binding stick and cover.
Tape.	More or less than two.
	Any fray, tear, or hole.
	Any uneven edge or thickness which will interfere with smooth operation.
	Any uneven or non-twisted yarn.
	Any softly or loosely woven area.
	Absence of tip or treatment on free end of tape.
Tape application.	Absence of stop plate or attachment to preclude pulling tape through slot of lower binding stick for style 3 and through slots of metal tape carrier for styles 1 and 2.
	Any free end not threaded through binding sticks and gripped by a buckle device for style 3.
Buckle-locking or ratchet-locking device.	Any material other than metal.
	Any non-secure attachment to the binding stick.
	Any feature tending to cut or mutilate the tape.
	Absence of specified coating or finish.
	Any failure to lock securely.
Fabric coverage.	Any nonbound binding stick for style 3.
	Failure to extend on inside of binder covers.
	Not applied as specified for styles 1 and 2.
Rivets.	Any not securely attached (when applicable).
Marking: Identification.	Missing, not as specified, incomplete, illegible.
	Not positioned as specified.
	Not in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

4.3.1.2 *Examination of the end item for defects in dimensions and capacities.* An examination shall be made as indicated in table III to determine that the dimensions and capacities of the binder conform to the requirements of this specification. Any dimension or capacity that does not conform with the requirements shall be a defect. The sample unit for this examination shall be one finished binder.

TABLE III.

Examine	Defects
Dimensions of covers.	Applicable paper sheets project beyond edges of covers; insufficient allowances for index tabs.
Length of tapes.	Less than specified lengths for rated capacities.
Slot spacing on binding sticks (all classes) and metal type carriers (classes 1 and 2).	Not specified distance ± 1/32 inch on centers.

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TABLE III.—(*Cont'd*)

Examine	Defects
Extension of binding material.	Distance of binding material carry over less than 1/2 inch as applicable.
Rated capacity.	Less than that specified.

4.3.1.3 *Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.* An examination shall be made as indicated in table IV to determine compliance with the packaging, packing, and marking requirements of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operation. Defects of closure listed in table IV shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2; and the AQL, 4.0 defects per 100 units.

TABLE IV.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior).	Incorrect; incomplete; illegible; omitted; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials.	Any nonconforming component; component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship.	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose or inadequate sealing, strapping, or stapling.
	Bulged or distorted containers.
Contents.	Number of binders per package is more or less than required.
Weight.	Net weight exceeds requirement.

4.3.1.4 *Inspection levels and AQL's.* The inspection levels for determining the sample size and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	*Inspection level*	*AQL*
4.3.1.1	II	4.0
4.3.1.2	S-2	4.0

4.3.1.5 *Testing of the end item.* The binders shall be tested for compliance with general operating requirements of this specification. For the evaluation tests specified in 4.4.4, the requirement is applicable to the sample unit which shall be one finished binder. One test shall be made per sample unit. The inspection level shall be S-1. The lot size shall be expressed in units of single binders. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 The weight of the binding material specified in 3.1.3 shall be determined in accordance with Method 5041 of Specification CCC-T-191.

4.4.2 The basis weight of the lining material specified in 3.1.4 shall be determined in accordance with Method 110 of Specification UU-P-31.

4.4.3 *Metal parts.* All exposed metal parts of the binder shall be tested for corrosion resistance by placing them in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of 15 minutes. The parts, upon being removed from this solution, shall be immediately immersed in 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature. They shall then be removed from this solution and, without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature. The metal parts shall then be rinsed in lukewarm water, allowed to dry, and examined for evidence of corrosion.

4.4.4 *Evaluation tests.* The evaluation tests for the binders shall consist of the following:

(1) The center ratchet-type and buckle-

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type locking devices shall be visually tested for slippage at various capacity settings.

(2) The tapes for styles 1 and 2 binders shall be visually examined for undue binding at various capacity settings. The tapes for style 3 binders shall be passed through the binding sticks, the inserted sheets and the buckle-type locking devices for visual examination of undue binding at various capacity settings.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurements, Fed. Std. No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging and packing specified.)

5.1 **Packaging.** Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Not more than six binders of one type, size, style, class, tape widths, and color only shall be packaged in a folding or set-up paperboard box conforming to the requirements of Specifications PPP-B-566 and PPP-B-676, respectively.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Packaging shall be as specified for level A.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Binders shall be packaged in accordance with the industry's normal practice.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Binders of one type, size, style, class, tape width, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class 2, V3c or V3s, style RSC of Specification PPP-B-636. Each fiberboard container shall have all seams, corners, and manufacturer's joints sealed by the application of 3-inch-minimum-width olive-drab color tape conforming to type III, class 1 of Specification PPP-T-60. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Binders of one type, size, style, class, tape width, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of Specification PPP-B-636. The minimum bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be 275 p.s.i. All flaps of the fiberboard shipping container shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of metal stitching the bottom flaps and sealing the top flaps with adhesive. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Binders, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military activities.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The binders covered by this specification are intended for use in filing records, reports, and other papers and

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for easy removal or insertion of one or more sheets.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein (see 3.5), and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type, size, style, and class required (see 1.2.1).
(*c*) Tape width required (see 1.2.1).
(*d*) Color of binding material and tape (see 3.1.3 and 3.1.5).
(*e*) Data; inspection responsibility if other than as specified in 4.1.
(*f*) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.3 **Transportation data.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Binders, loose-leaf, cloth.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Binders, loose-leaf, cloth.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Army—GL

Navy—S & A

Air Force—**MOA**

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